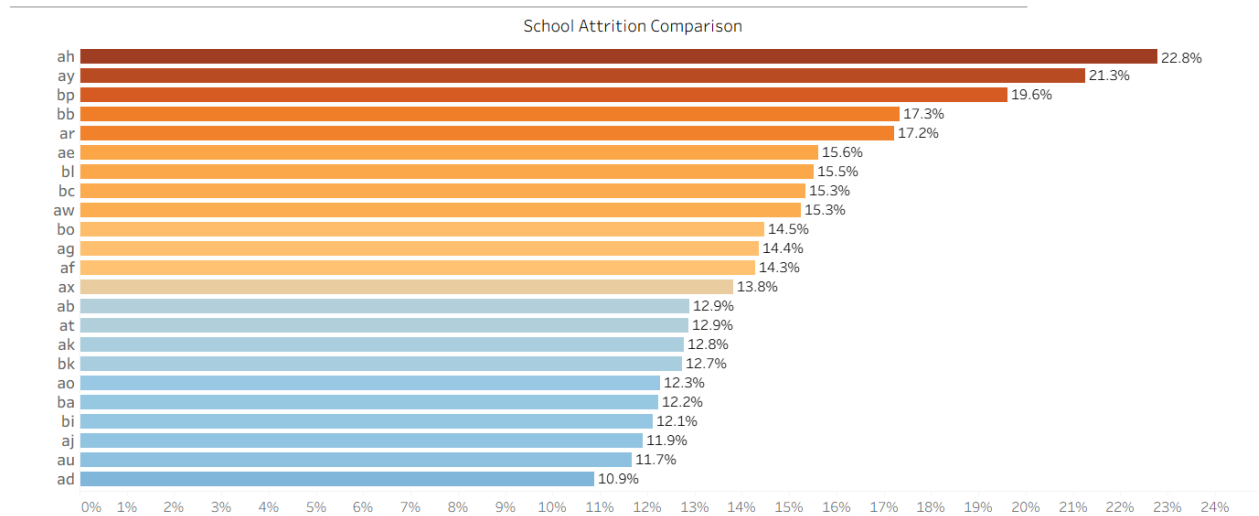


1. Why did you choose this particular visualization?

School Attrition Comparison (Horizontal Bar Chart)



I selected a sorted horizontal bar chart for school comparison view, prioritizing fast scanability for the Student Recruitment and Enrollment team.

- **Sorted Descending Rank:** Sorting schools in descending order by Attrition, allowing the viewers to instantly spot high-priority schools without having to manually scan and compare values.
- **Data Labels:** Percentage labels are included at the end of the horizontal bars, eliminating the need to trace gridlines back to the X-axis once the viewer establishes the context.
- **Color Encoding:** Colors draw attention to high-priority schools in red/dark orange.
- **Cross Filtering:** Allows the viewer to click on any individual school within the bar chart to granularly and dynamically explore the data on a grade-by-grade basis and year level within the Mid-Year Attrition by Grade Level view.

2. What would you improve in your visualization?

- **Region and School Control:** Introduce a filter dropdown for region (Brooklyn, Connecticut, and Rhode Island) in addition to the school level (Elementary, Middle, and High) and school size (Low, Medium, High). This allows the Recruitment and Enrollment team more flexibility in isolating geographic locations and specified grades at a granular level.
- **School Selector:** Introduce a multi-select dropdown filter and search functionality for individual schools. This allows the viewer to isolate and

compare schools that they want to specifically see without needing to scroll through the full network list (visual clutter).

- **Parameter Control:** Incorporate a parameter toggle that allows the user to switch between the Attrition Rate (% , Default) and Total Exit Volume (Count). Attrition rate can be skewed due to school size (Low, Medium, High). An example of this is the 3rd school “bp” with an attrition rate of 19.6% but only offers Grades K-1 with a total active cohort of 153.

3. **What would be your conclusions and recommendations to AF's Team Student Recruitment and Enrollment based on this visualization?**

- **Middle School Concentration:** Among the top 10 schools with the highest attrition rates, the vast majority are middle schools (including growing schools such as “bl” (grades 5-7) across 2019-2021).
- **Grade 8 Transition:** Across the network, 8th grade consistently experiences the highest “mid-year drop-off”, which is steadily increased from **31%** to **33.1%** between 2019 and 2021.

From this conclusion, my recommendation to the Student Recruitment and Enrollment team would be to partner up with school operations at affected middle schools, gathering exit survey data from parents choosing not to re-enroll with achievement first after 8th grade. Identifying these root causes will help the team understand the key drivers of attrition and implement effective retention initiatives.

Key Definition and Notes:

Unique Student (Dedupe): Students with multiple enrollment records within the same academic year are only counted once, preventing inflating exit counts.

Grade 12 Filter: Grade 12 is excluded from the global data source filter. Graduation results in a 100% exit rate, which skews and inflates overall mid-year attrition.

Year 2019-2021 Filter: The data is filtered to academic years 2019-2021 through the school year, endyear.